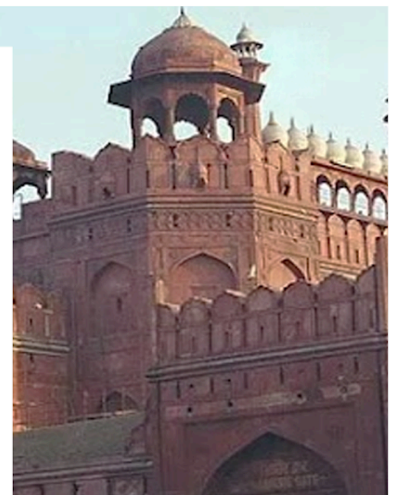
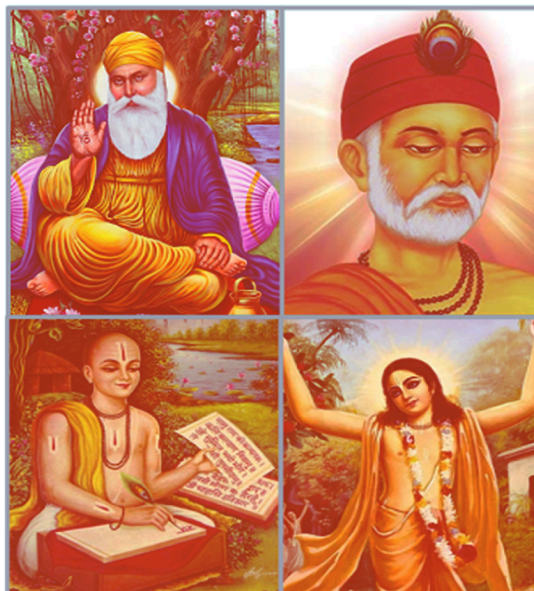
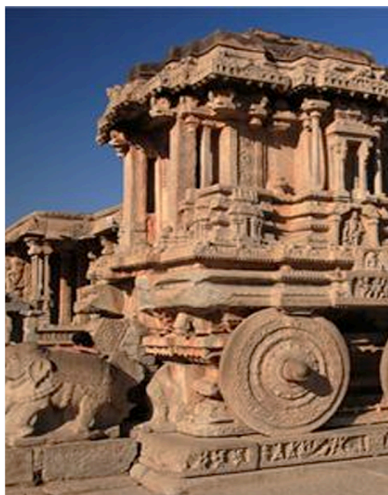


# **General Knowledge**

## **Medieval History**

### **STUDY NOTES**

**Shahjahan**



## Shahjahan (1627-1658 AD)



### Early Life

- Shahjahan's original name is **Shahab-ud-din Muhammad Khurram (Prince Khurram)**. 'Shahjahan' was the name of the title he received in the Battle of Deccan. It means 'conqueror of the world'.
- Prince Khurram's birth in Lahore is dated **5 January 1592 AD**.
- He was born to Jahangir and his Rajput wife from Marwar Princess Jagat Gosaini. Jagat Gosaini's official Mughal name was Bilqis Makani.
- Primarily he was raised by **Empress Ruqaiya Sultan Begum**, and educated in martial arts and fine arts.

### Personal Life

- Shah Jahan married multiple times, with **Arjumand Banu Begum (Mumtaz Mahal)** being his favourite.
- After her death during childbirth in 1631, he commissioned the Taj Mahal in her honour.

### Accession to Throne

- After Jahangir's death in **1627**, he defeated rivals, including his brother Shahryar, and was crowned on **February 14, 1628, in Agra**.

## Military Achievements

- Known for his military prowess, he secured the Rajput state of Mewar, which had resisted Mughal rule since Akbar's time.

### Battle of Ahmadnagar-I (1616 AD):

- Emperor Jahangir made Prince Khurram in charge of the southern command and gave him the task of capturing Ahmednagar.
- Emperor Jahangir was happy with Prince Khurram's success and conferred on him the royal title of 'Shahjahan'.

### Battle of Ahmadnagar-II (1620 AD):

- By 1636 AD, The kingdoms of Bijapur, and Golconda were also made to pay tribute to the emperor.

## Fights with Portuguese (1631 AD)

### Portuguese's Objectionable Policy:

- The Portuguese had established a factory in **1537 AD at Hugli in Bengal**.
- A lot of the Portuguese population was settled at Hugli till the rule of the Shahjahan.
- The Portuguese had a very stringent religious policy.
- They often lifted the orphaned children and converted them to Christianity. This was something objectionable under the Mughal emperors.

### Mughal-Safavid War (1638 AD):

- It was a battle for **taking Qandahar** under Mughal control.
- Shahjahan realized the importance of Qandahar to the Mughal empire.
- He waged a war against the Persians and took the Qandahar back.

### Balkh Campaign:

- Shah Jahan made a new objective to secure a friendly ruler in Balkh and Badakhshan, which were the areas bordering Kabul. The Mughals had been ruled over by Timurid princes earlier till 1585 AD.



- Shahjahan was a success. The campaign became successful as the Mughals were able to conquer Balkh and defeat Uzbek attempts.

## Mughal Political Territory during Shahjahan's rule



## Policies

### Religious Tolerance:

- Advocated for equality between Hindus and Muslims, celebrating various cultural festivities and promoting a blend of Hindi and Persian in court.

### Land Revenue Reforms:

- Adjusted revenue policies to ease burdens on peasants while increasing state revenue.

## Administration:

### Political:

- Shahjahan was the energetic and brave son of Jahangir.
- As a Prince, he had been the governor of the Deccan, Bihar, Bengal, Gujarat, and Delhi respectively. So, he had administrative experience.

### Economic:

- He contributed to boosting trade and commerce outside India.
- Sea voyages increased to import and export of goods and military equipment.
- Central Asia and Iran are well connected to India.

### Military System:

- Shahjahan had an ambition of making a very strong army.
- He invested most of his time in strengthening the army structure.
- Historians said that Shahjahan's army included more than 911,400 soldiers and 185,000 cavalry.

## Contributions to Architecture

### Architectural Legacy:

- Shah Jahan was a major supporter of Mughal architecture, marking the golden age of this style.

- His most famous structure is the Taj Mahal, built out of love for Mumtaz Mahal.

### Design and Construction:

- The Taj Mahal took twenty years to complete, crafted from white marble with brick underlayment, involving architects from around the world.

### Influence on Culture:

- His relationship with Mumtaz Mahal has influenced Indian art, literature, and film.
- Notable Structures:



Red Fort, Delhi



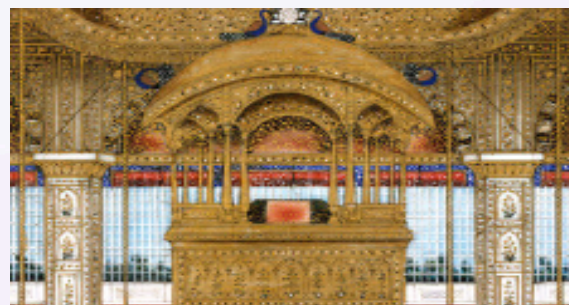
Agra Fort



Jama Masjid



Moti Masjid



| Taj Mahal                                                                                                 | The Peacock Throne                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <p>Shalimar Gardens</p> |  <p>Wazir Khan Mosque</p> |

## Death and Legacy

- In 1658, after falling ill, his son Dara Shikoh took on regent duties. This led to conflict with his other sons, Shuja and Aurangzeb.
- Aurangzeb defeated Dara Shikoh and imprisoned Shah Jahan in Agra Fort until his death on January 22, 1666.
- Laid to rest alongside Mumtaz Mahal in the Taj Mahal.
- His reign fostered a rich cultural environment and left a lasting architectural legacy, including the **UNESCO World Heritage-listed Taj Mahal**.